

Seawall height in Hollywood

The elevation your city requires, the datum it is measured in, and the section of code that says so.

HOLLYWOOD • BROWARD COUNTY

4.0

ft NAVD88 until 2035

Four feet NAVD88 for a barrier built before 1 January 2035, rising to five feet by 2050. The rule comes from the county, which required every Broward city to adopt it locally by February 2022.

The detail

BEFORE 1 JANUARY 2035	4 ft NAVD88
BY 2050	5 ft NAVD88
WHAT TRIGGERS IT	A new barrier, or an existing one substantially improved by more than 50% in length or cost.
WHERE THE RULE COMES FROM	Broward County Code Chapter 39, Article XXV, Resiliency Standards for Tidal Flood Protection.
WORTH KNOWING	Building to 4 ft today means the wall has to come up again before 2050. Ask what it costs to build for 5 ft now.

Where this comes from: Broward County Code Ch. 39, Art. XXV; City of Hollywood, Sea Walls & Other Tidal Flood Barriers guidance

Verified: 2026-09. Rules change — check the date above against today.

Before you call a contractor

1 Know your datum

A height means nothing without the datum it is measured from. NAVD88 and MLW are different reference points and the same wall gives different numbers in each. Ask which one any quoted elevation refers to.

2 Get the existing elevation surveyed

You cannot tell whether a wall meets the requirement by looking at it. A surveyor shooting the top of the cap settles it in an hour.

3

Ask what triggers the requirement

Most cities only apply the minimum to new walls or to substantial repair. What counts as substantial is defined differently in each city, and it is usually a percentage of length or of cost.

4

Ask about building higher now

Several cities require a wall built below the final figure to be engineered so it can be raised later. Doing it once is cheaper than doing it twice.